# Humana. Claims Payment Policy

# Subject: Claim Disputes

**Application:** Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Products
**Policy number:** CP2016004
**Related policies:** N/A

**Published date:** 11/2016
**Revision date:** 04/2026

***Disclaimer:*** *The intended audience of this medical claims payment policy is healthcare providers who treat Humana members. This policy is made available to provide information on certain Humana claims payment policies. This policy is a guideline only and does not constitute medical advice, guarantee of payment, plan pre-authorization, an explanation of benefits, or a contract. This policy does not govern whether a procedure is covered under a specific member plan or policy, nor is it intended to address every claim situation. Claims may be affected by other factors, such as: state and federal laws and regulations, provider contract terms, and our professional judgment. This policy is subject to change or termination by Humana. Humana has full and final discretionary authority for its interpretation and application. No part of this policy may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise without express written permission from Humana. When printed, this version becomes uncontrolled. For the most current information, always refer to the following website:* ***Humana.com/ClaimPaymentPolicies***

## Overview

Humana adjudicates a claim for services provided to a plan member based on the information submitted in that claim and information related to that claim. If a *qualified healthcare provider* disagrees with Humana's adjudication of that claim, based on the information submitted in that claim, that provider may submit to Humana a request for a *dispute* review of the plan's determination. If a provider submits a request for a *dispute* review timely and with all required information, Humana will review the claim to determine whether to revise the adjudication. Humana plans may use medical records and other available relevant documentation to review a *dispute*.

This policy establishes the applicable timeframe for a *qualified healthcare provider* submission of a *dispute* request.

***Note***: A *corrected claim* is a provider's submission of information that constitutes a material change to an existing claim. A claim submission that constitutes a material change to an existing claim is not a disagreement about Humana's adjudication of the claim as based on the information in the previous claim submission. Therefore, Humana plans will not review a *corrected claim* as a *dispute*.

**Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Payment Policy**
**Additional Resources on this Topic**
**Definitions of *Italicized* Terms**
**References**
**General Humana Resources**

# Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Payment Policy

*In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.*

A *qualified healthcare provider* may contest the payment, denial or nonpayment of a claim in writing with at least the following information:

- Member name and identification number
- Date of service
- Relationship of the subscriber to the patient
- Claim number
- Name, National Provider Identifier (NPI) and tax identification number of the provider of the services
- Charge amount
- Payment amount
- Proposed correct payment amount
- Difference between the amount paid and the proposed correct payment amount
- Brief explanation of the basis for the contestation request
- Relevant supporting documentation, such as, medical records, invoice, or referral form

***Note:*** Information about the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) administrative appeal processes is available at Humana.com/Appeals.

## Medicare Advantage Specific Requirements

Unless otherwise stated in the contract, an in-network *qualified healthcare provider* may submit a *dispute* request within 18 months from the receipt of the original claim determination.

An out-of-network *qualified healthcare provider* may submit a *dispute* request within 180 days from the receipt of the original claim determination.

Multiple provider *dispute* requests per provider encounter are generally unacceptable. It is necessary, therefore, in a provider *dispute* request after an initial *dispute* determination, to explicitly identify specific new material information that justifies further review.

## Medicaid Specific Requirements

Unless otherwise stated in the contract, an in-network *qualified healthcare provider* may submit a *dispute* request within 18 months from the receipt of the original claim determination.

An out-of-network *qualified healthcare provider* does not have a contractual relationship with a particular plan that would afford that *qualified healthcare provider* direct rights against that plan. An out-of-network *qualified healthcare provider* lacks, for example, the right to submit a claim, the right to require the plan to process a claim seeking a member's plan or policy benefits, the right to submit a *dispute* request and the right to submit *corrected claims*. Those examples are not exhaustive.

Without waiving any provisions that prohibit an out-of-network *qualified healthcare provider* from assuming an enrollee's direct rights against the plan, a plan will allow an out-of-network *qualified healthcare provider* to submit a *dispute* request within:

- The timeframe established by state or federal laws, or
- 180 days from the receipt of the original claim determination when the applicable state and federal laws are silent.

## Additional Resources on this Topic

Humana's Making it Easier web-based training series includes a video on Humana's processes for medical claim disputes and corrected claims that may supplement your understanding of this policy.

## Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Corrected claim:*** A claim that replaces a previously submitted claim and includes material information that differs from information included in the previously submitted claim. For this purpose, "material information" is information that, because it differs from information included in the previously submitted claim, could cause some change in reimbursement if that information were considered.
- ***Dispute:*** A disagreement about a previous claim determination that does not entail a change to the material information submitted for that claim. The dispute must be presented in writing, challenging the potentially adverse determination of the claim based on the previously submitted information. Medical notes, industry standards and/or Original Medicare guidelines may be used to support a dispute request.
- ***Qualified healthcare provider:*** A provider who is licensed by the appropriate state agency to diagnose or treat a sickness or bodily injury and provide preventive services.

## References

- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Original Medicare (Fee-for-service) Appeals. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 34 – Reopening and Revision of Claim Determinations and Decisions. Section 10 – Reopening and Revision of Claims Determination and Decisions - General www.cms.gov.

## General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

**Note**: Links to sources outside of Humana's control are verified at the time of publication. Please report broken links.